New Schedule, New Emotions

Arma Rahman, General News

Every year there are some new changes made in schools, whether it be hiring new teachers, seeing staff leave or retire, new policies, new schedules. All of these apply for the new year at Edison. One of the biggest changes that affected both students and teachers is the new schedule.

Last year there were two sessions, one from 8AM-2:20PM and another one from 8:49AM-3:18PM. However a new session has been introduced which begins at 9:36AM-5:46PM. Everyone raised the questions, why was it necessary to introduce a third session?

Bell Schedule

Thomas A. Edison Career & Technical Education H.S. · 2026-2027

PERIOD	BEGINS	ENDS	DURATION
Period 1	8:00 AM	8:44 AM	44 min
Period 2	8:48 AM	9:32 AM	44 min
Period 3	9:36 AM	10:20 AM	44 min
Period 4	10:24 AM	11:08 AM	44 min
Period 5	11:12 AM	11:56 AM	44 min
Period 6	12:00 PM	12:44 PM	44 min
Period 7	12:48 PM	1:32 PM	44 min
Period 8	1:36 PM	2:20 PM	44 min
Period 9	2:24 PM	3:08 PM	44 min
Period 10	3:12 PM	3:56 PM	44 min

Session Schedule

Session	Periods
Session A	Periods 1 – 8
Session B	Periods 2 – 9
Session C	Periods 3 – 10

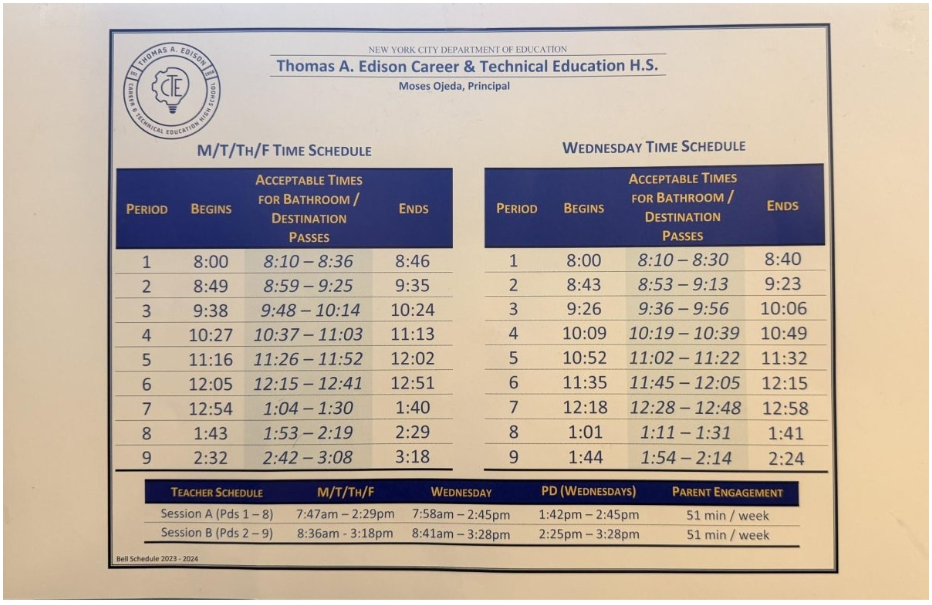
Arma Rahman

The new bell schedule Edison students will be following

"There's a law that so many people when it comes to class size reduction they think that that's an Edison thing. It's a state thing. It's a law that was enacted where we must have 25 students in a class by 2028 or 29. I think they had extended it because we're having a hard time hiring teachers. So in order to meet those requirements we had to go through a third session because we don't have enough rooms at Edison," Mr. Ojeda said.

The introduction of the new schedule along with slight changes has impacted students. Some having the same session they have had last year or some having a completely different session; the results have been mixed.

Himandee Liyanage, a senior, had a 2-8 session last year. However this year, they have a different and longer session, starting first period and ending ninth period. They described having a different session from last year making them feel more tired.



NEW YORK CITY DEPARTMENT OF EDUCATION
Thomas A. Edison Career & Technical Education H.S.
Moses Ojeda, Principal

M/T/TH/F TIME SCHEDULE

PERIOD	BEGINS	ACCEPTABLE TIMES FOR BATHROOM / DESTINATION PASSES	ENDS
1	8:00	8:10 – 8:36	8:46
2	8:49	8:59 – 9:25	9:35
3	9:38	9:48 – 10:14	10:24
4	10:27	10:37 – 11:03	11:13
5	11:16	11:26 – 11:52	12:02
6	12:05	12:15 – 12:41	12:51
7	12:54	1:04 – 1:30	1:40
8	1:43	1:53 – 2:19	2:29
9	2:32	2:42 – 3:08	3:18

WEDNESDAY TIME SCHEDULE

PERIOD	BEGINS	ACCEPTABLE TIMES FOR BATHROOM / DESTINATION PASSES	ENDS
1	8:00	8:10 – 8:30	8:40
2	8:43	8:53 – 9:13	9:23
3	9:26	9:36 – 9:56	10:06
4	10:09	10:19 – 10:39	10:49
5	10:52	11:02 – 11:22	11:32
6	11:35	11:45 – 12:05	12:15
7	12:18	12:28 – 12:48	12:58
8	1:01	1:11 – 1:31	1:41
9	1:44	1:54 – 2:14	2:24

TEACHER SCHEDULE	M/T/TH/F	WEDNESDAY	PD (WEDNESDAYS)	PARENT ENGAGEMENT
Session A (Pds 1 – 8)	7:47am – 2:29pm	7:58am – 2:45pm	1:42pm – 2:45pm	51 min / week
Session B (Pds 2 – 9)	8:36am - 3:18pm	8:41am – 3:28pm	2:25pm – 3:28pm	51 min / week

Bell Schedule 2023 - 2024

The old Edison schedule along with the Wednesday schedule (Tasruba Muskan)

Another senior has the opposite session. Andrea Nauta, a senior, begins the first period and ends the fifth period. This can be a positive experience for some students as they get to leave school early and get to start things early. But it can also be a negative experience for some students, like Andrea, who want to hangout with their friends.

“It used to be that I would hang out with my friends and go home together as we ended similar times at either 8 or 9. Now that I end 5th I can no longer be with them but I have been able to go home and do my responsibilities much earlier,” Andrea said.

Some students do not have conflicts at the time they are starting or ending, but with how their classes are put together or the fact that they don't have a lunch period.

Muhammad Ally, a senior, goes in depth about how the schedule has affected him personally.

“I had a 1-8 session last year, and I think with this new schedule, it was hard to come to terms with the new periods. Moving through Edison for 3 years, and having the bell ring at exactly certain times became a normal for many, and with the change, it was hard to adjust in the beginning, as sometimes you'd lost track of time, and then you'd have to hurry to beat the traffic in the hallways. Also, with some schedules, you don't have a lunch period, which can either be really good, or really bad. For me, it was another hard adjustment because I don't usually like to eat in class, and now that we are almost two months into the new school year, I've gotten adjusted to and sorted out my lunch schedule, but nevertheless, it was still something that took time to adjust with,” Muhammad said.

Some other students on the other hand are satisfied with their schedule even if they are a bit disappointed.

Leslie Ferrer, a senior, had a 1-8 session last year, this year they start 2nd period but still end 8th.

“Starting second period was rough at first but over time I started appreciating it more. Last year as a junior I started first period; it was easier for me because my dad was able to drop me off every day. However, now that I start second period my parents aren't able to drop me off at school anymore so there are some days where I have to walk. But I got used to starting later and I actually started to appreciate it more because I get to sleep a couple of extra minutes and have time for myself rather than rushing to school every day,” Leslie said.

Some teachers are glad that they did not receive the 3-10 session. Some were even worried about students who would have to get home late due to their new schedules.

Ms. Cruz, a shop teacher of Web and App Development, said, “I'll just say that I'm happy. I didn't get the 3 to 10 schedule, because I feel like coming in, logistically, if I were to come in at the time for the third period, I wouldn't find parking. I would have to still kind of follow that one or second period schedule, just to be able to find parking with no, with no issues. So I think it is a long day, especially for teachers who do travel far, and more importantly, for students who have to get up, you know, super early or have to be late, and travel on their own when it gets dark at night.”

Other than the introduction of the new schedule, many students were enraged by the removal of the Wednesday schedule. The Wednesday schedule reduced class time by ~4 mins and allowed students to get out of school earlier than their usual dismissal time.

Principal Ojeda explained that Edison used to be a PROSE school meaning the UFT (United Federation of Teachers) and NYC Public School System would come together and create their committee that allows you to change policy in place and most of the time the policy would be related to scheduling. But, to do this you had to vote to be a PROSE school. This is done every two-three years however this year the vote did not pass. Due to this, Edison had to switch to the new schedule.

They made minor changes however they could not keep the Wednesday schedule as it was voted down.

“I feel so incredibly sad that Wednesdays no longer exist. I feel like when we ended early it would let me have some sort of break when it comes to school. Sometimes school can be overwhelming so having a day where we can end early is like a breath of fresh air. I feel like it also gives students a break because like I said school is overwhelming and having a time where we end early not only helps with our school life but social life as well. I also think it was kind of unfair to remove it my senior year,” Mirian Menchu, a senior, said.

Many students even used the Wednesday schedule as a motivation to get through halfway through the week and felt more relaxed to get out earlier to hangout with their friends. Or even as a break for students to have free time for themselves to study or relax.

“Very disappointed as the Wednesday schedule was what everyone was looking forward to and it allowed for people to hang out and get work done rather than have no time for anything than school,” Anjalie Persaud, a junior, said.

“I feel as though it was unnecessary because the shorter Wednesdays were a sort of middle ground/break for students to get home early and have time for themselves whether it’s to rest or study more in depth,” Sumiya Akter, a senior, said.

Kashfia Nayim, a senior, explains that the Wednesday schedule allowed students to have a small break within the week and helped with stress. She also explained knowing that the teachers were in meetings discussing important things felt nice.

The removal of the Wednesday schedule has not only affected students, but also the teachers.

Ms. Cruz, shop teacher of Web and App Development, explains that the removal of the schedule allowed her to know the specific tasks she had to complete and they had more continuity during Wednesdays as they could meet with their teams at least once a week.

Many are now wondering, is it possible to bring back the Wednesday schedule and go back to two sessions?

Principal Ojeda says it can be possible, if he manages to meet three factors.



Room 317 under construction (Arma Rahman)

“The factors that went into the three sessions were an increase in enrollment, having rooms under construction because I’m thinking ahead I need to make one room at Edison to be able to meet the requirement of the 25 and then that law of 25. Those are the three deciding factors that really went into the third session. And so if I can get those rooms and accommodate everyone then maybe we can think about going back to two sessions if it allows it,” Mr. Ojeda said.

As of right now, most students want the Wednesday schedule back.

“Bring back Wednesdays because I feel like that made school more easier to get through rather than having a schedule that is both full and complicated. I don’t mind my schedule in general but having Wednesdays is more reasonable for me,” Mirian Menchu said.